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FC1042

FROM WASHINGTON TO FOREIGN OFFICE

Cypher/OTP

FOREIGN OFFICE AND
WHITEHALL SECRET(CABINET)

Sir R. Makins
No.2538
November 26, 1954.

D.7.35 p.m. November 26, 1954.
R.9.21 p.m. November 26, 1954.

PRIORITY
SECRET

Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No.2538 of November 26

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FC1042/1866

My telegram No.2532: Quemoy and Formosa.

The New Zealand Minister (Laking) and I saw Mr. Murphy (heavily supported by experts) this morning.

2. Laking, on instructions, made two points: first, that unless the Exchange of Notes was published fact that Formosa was not to be a "privileged sanctuary" would not be clear. In the second place the New Zealand Government would prefer that the joint statement should not specify the various security treaties entered into by the United States.

3. Murphy promised to put these points to Mr. Dulles on his return. I said that your difficulty related to the first of the two points made by Mr. Laking. Her Majesty's Government regognized that the arrangements in substance met the requirements that Formosa was not to be a base for offensive operations and that there was no American obligation to defend the off-shore islands; but the joint statement was far from making these points clear.

4. Murphy replied that lack of clarity was deliberate to avoid giving information to the Communists and to avoid giving them an incentive to attack the islands.

5. I said I could understand this. At the same time the effect on the Security Council exercise had to be kept in mind. In your view action, if taken, would have to proceed on the basis of the publication of all the documents. To meet criticism in the United Kingdom and from world opinion (and in particular Asian opinion) it would have to be made clear that there would be

/no American

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no American support for Nationalist operations against the mainland.

6. Murphy seemed not to know what was in Mr. Dulles' mind as regards publication of Exchange of Notes but undertook to pass on your views to him on return.

7. To avoid any possible misunderstanding I said (and Laking endorsed me) that you would not be able to give your assent or support to the projected Security Council operation until these questions had been cleared up. In the circumstances I thought it would be better to delay publication of the joint statement at present planned for November 30. Murphy agreed with this suggestion.

8. I took the opportunity to confirm the assumptions in the second paragraph of my telegram No.2533, first of which is of particular importance.

9. I then asked whether I might be given the texts of the Treaty and of the Exchange of Notes for passing to you. I expressed my thanks for the opportunity to take notes of these documents but of course this was not quite the same thing. Murphy was embarrassed by this request and said that he could not agree to it without further reference to Mr. Dulles.

10. Position therefore is that nothing more can happen until Dulles is back in the State Department Tuesday. I feel confident that the joint statement will not be published on November 30 but will be held up. Having made the points in your telegram No.5795 to Murphy this morning in the presence of his advisers, I think it preferable to leave it at that for the time being and not to put anything in writing at this stage.

B B B